Records Management Handbook

Corporate governance series, edition 4

Chapter 1: Purpose and scope

Staff who work with purpose and scope are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. New starters receive guidance on purpose and scope during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Guidance on purpose and scope is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Any incident involving purpose and scope must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Regular sampling is used to check that purpose and scope meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter.

Guidance on purpose and scope is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. The organisation aims to make purpose and scope simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. When responsibilities for purpose and scope change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Any incident involving purpose and scope must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Regular sampling is used to check that purpose and scope meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter.

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Chapter 2: Roles and responsibilities

Guidance on roles and responsibilities is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Staff who work with roles and responsibilities are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. The organisation aims to make roles and responsibilities simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Where a system supports roles and responsibilities, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. Each business unit must document how roles and responsibilities is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months.

Any incident involving roles and responsibilities must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Each business unit must document how roles and responsibilities is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Guidance on roles and responsibilities is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. New starters receive guidance on roles and responsibilities during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Where a system supports roles and responsibilities, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

Exceptions to the rules on roles and responsibilities require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. When responsibilities for roles and responsibilities change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Regular sampling is used to check that roles and responsibilities meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Where a system supports roles and responsibilities, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. The organisation aims to make roles and responsibilities simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit.

Chapter 3: Classifying records

When responsibilities for classifying records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. The organisation aims to make classifying records simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Staff who work with classifying records are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. New starters receive guidance on classifying records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Where a system supports classifying records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 4: Creating records

New starters receive guidance on creating records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Guidance on creating records is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Any incident involving creating records must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Exceptions to the rules on creating records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Each business unit must document how creating records is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months.

When responsibilities for creating records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. The organisation aims to make creating records simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Any incident involving creating records must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Guidance on creating records is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Each business unit must document how creating records is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months.

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Chapter 5: Naming and filing conventions

Regular sampling is used to check that naming and filing conventions meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. When responsibilities for naming and filing conventions change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Any incident involving naming and filing conventions must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Guidance on naming and filing conventions is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. The organisation aims to make naming and filing conventions simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit.

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Chapter 6: Email as a record

Any incident involving email as a record must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Exceptions to the rules on email as a record require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Staff who work with email as a record are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. New starters receive guidance on email as a record during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. When responsibilities for email as a record change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register.

Any incident involving email as a record must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Guidance on email as a record is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Regular sampling is used to check that email as a record meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. The organisation aims to make email as a record simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Exceptions to the rules on email as a record require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

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Chapter 7: Digital storage and backup

When responsibilities for digital storage and backup change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Exceptions to the rules on digital storage and backup require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Regular sampling is used to check that digital storage and backup meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Guidance on digital storage and backup is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Where a system supports digital storage and backup, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 8: Physical records and off-site storage

Regular sampling is used to check that physical records and off-site storage meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Any incident involving physical records and off-site storage must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. The organisation aims to make physical records and off-site storage simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Guidance on physical records and off-site storage is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Exceptions to the rules on physical records and off-site storage require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

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Chapter 9: Access and permissions

The organisation aims to make access and permissions simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Regular sampling is used to check that access and permissions meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Any incident involving access and permissions must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Staff who work with access and permissions are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Exceptions to the rules on access and permissions require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

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Chapter 10: Retention schedules

Each business unit must document how retention schedules is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Staff who work with retention schedules are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Guidance on retention schedules is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Exceptions to the rules on retention schedules require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Regular sampling is used to check that retention schedules meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter.

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Chapter 11: Legal holds

New starters receive guidance on legal holds during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Where a system supports legal holds, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. Each business unit must document how legal holds is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. The organisation aims to make legal holds simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Guidance on legal holds is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it.

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Chapter 12: Disposal and destruction

Where a system supports disposal and destruction, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. Guidance on disposal and destruction is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Regular sampling is used to check that disposal and destruction meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Any incident involving disposal and destruction must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Exceptions to the rules on disposal and destruction require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

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Chapter 13: Migrating records between systems

Retention periods are set out in the Juniper Ledger retention schedule. Financial records are kept for seven years after the end of the financial year to which they relate, personnel records for seven years after employment ends, and project records for five years after project closure. At the end of the period, the record owner confirms that no legal hold applies before disposal is authorised.

New starters receive guidance on migrating records between systems during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Each business unit must document how migrating records between systems is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. The organisation aims to make migrating records between systems simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Regular sampling is used to check that migrating records between systems meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Exceptions to the rules on migrating records between systems require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

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Chapter 14: Metadata standards

The organisation aims to make metadata standards simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Exceptions to the rules on metadata standards require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. When responsibilities for metadata standards change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Regular sampling is used to check that metadata standards meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Where a system supports metadata standards, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 15: Contracts and agreements

The organisation aims to make contracts and agreements simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Each business unit must document how contracts and agreements is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Any incident involving contracts and agreements must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. When responsibilities for contracts and agreements change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. New starters receive guidance on contracts and agreements during induction and a refresher is offered every two years.

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Chapter 16: Financial records

Where a system supports financial records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. When responsibilities for financial records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Regular sampling is used to check that financial records meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Exceptions to the rules on financial records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Any incident involving financial records must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected.

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Chapter 17: Personnel records

When responsibilities for personnel records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Regular sampling is used to check that personnel records meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Any incident involving personnel records must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. Staff who work with personnel records are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Where a system supports personnel records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 18: Project records

Exceptions to the rules on project records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Each business unit must document how project records is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Staff who work with project records are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Guidance on project records is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. New starters receive guidance on project records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years.

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Chapter 19: Meeting records and minutes

Regular sampling is used to check that meeting records and minutes meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. The organisation aims to make meeting records and minutes simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Exceptions to the rules on meeting records and minutes require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Guidance on meeting records and minutes is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Where a system supports meeting records and minutes, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 20: Audits and inspections

Each business unit must document how audits and inspections is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. New starters receive guidance on audits and inspections during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Where a system supports audits and inspections, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. The organisation aims to make audits and inspections simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. When responsibilities for audits and inspections change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register.

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Chapter 21: Training and awareness

Regular sampling is used to check that training and awareness meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Staff who work with training and awareness are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Each business unit must document how training and awareness is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Exceptions to the rules on training and awareness require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Where a system supports training and awareness, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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Chapter 22: Managing vital records

Records that support essential services are placed in the Sable Orchard recovery tier, which is restored first after any disruption. Backups of these records are tested every quarter and stored in a second location at least fifty kilometres from the primary site. The test results are reported to the governance committee.

The organisation aims to make managing vital records simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. New starters receive guidance on managing vital records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Guidance on managing vital records is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. When responsibilities for managing vital records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Exceptions to the rules on managing vital records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

Guidance on managing vital records is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Each business unit must document how managing vital records is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. When responsibilities for managing vital records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. Where a system supports managing vital records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. Regular sampling is used to check that managing vital records meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter.

Exceptions to the rules on managing vital records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Any incident involving managing vital records must be reported to the records officer within two working days so that the cause can be corrected. When responsibilities for managing vital records change hands, the outgoing owner must brief their successor and update the register. New starters receive guidance on managing vital records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Each business unit must document how managing vital records is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months.

Chapter 23: Disaster recovery for records

New starters receive guidance on disaster recovery for records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. The organisation aims to make disaster recovery for records simple to follow, consistent across departments and easy to audit. Regular sampling is used to check that disaster recovery for records meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Exceptions to the rules on disaster recovery for records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register. Where a system supports disaster recovery for records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it.

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New starters receive guidance on disaster recovery for records during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Regular sampling is used to check that disaster recovery for records meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter. Staff who work with disaster recovery for records are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Where a system supports disaster recovery for records, the system administrator keeps a written description of the configuration and any changes made to it. Exceptions to the rules on disaster recovery for records require written approval from the records manager and are logged in the exceptions register.

Chapter 24: Review and continuous improvement

New starters receive guidance on review and continuous improvement during induction and a refresher is offered every two years. Each business unit must document how review and continuous improvement is handled and name a responsible owner who reviews the arrangement at least once every twelve months. Guidance on review and continuous improvement is reviewed whenever legislation, technology or business needs change in a way that affects it. Staff who work with review and continuous improvement are expected to follow the procedures in this handbook and to raise any uncertainty with the records officer before acting. Regular sampling is used to check that review and continuous improvement meets the standards set here, and the results are reported to the governance committee each quarter.

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Document control

This handbook is owned by the records manager and reviewed annually.